



United States
Attorney's Office
District of New Jersey



Connecticut Man Sentenced to 30 Months' Imprisonment for Role in \$7.8 Million Health Care Fraud and Kickback Scheme

Thursday, December 18, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, District of New Jersey

NEWARK, N.J. – A Connecticut man was sentenced yesterday to 30 months' imprisonment for his role in a multimillion-dollar durable medical equipment (DME) health care fraud and kickback scheme, Senior Counsel Philip Lamparello announced.

Jesse Foote, 60, of Fairfield, Connecticut, previously pleaded guilty before U.S. District Judge Esther Salas in Newark federal court to a two-count information charging him with conspiracy to violate the Federal Anti-Kickback statute and conspiracy to commit health care fraud.

According to documents filed in this case and statements made in court:

From December 2017 to March 2021, Foote conspired with overseas telemarketing call centers, DME suppliers, telemedicine companies, and doctors to submit fraudulent claims to health care benefit programs, including Medicare and TRICARE, through a circular scheme of kickbacks and bribes. Foote controlled a marketing company through which he purchased patient "leads" from overseas telemarketing companies. The leads consisted of information about Medicare and other beneficiaries and pre-written doctors' orders for DME. The telemarketing call centers targeted Medicare beneficiaries and others with health insurance to persuade them to accept DME, including orthotic braces, without regard to medical necessity. Foote paid bribes and kickbacks to telemedicine companies, which in turn paid bribes and kickbacks to doctors, to obtain doctors' orders for DME based on the leads. The doctors often approved the DME orders without having any contact with the beneficiary and without making a bona fide assessment that the DME was medically necessary. Foote then sold the signed doctors' orders to others with whom he had kickback arrangements. The doctors' orders were ultimately submitted to DME suppliers, including DME suppliers controlled by Foote, which submitted fraudulent claims for reimbursement to health care benefit programs including Medicare, TRICARE, and private insurance companies.

In total, Foote and his co-conspirators caused the submission of false and fraudulent claims to health care benefit programs totaling more than \$7.8 million for DME.

In addition to the prison term, Judge Salas sentenced Foote to three years of supervised release and ordered him to pay \$7,878,991.56 in restitution.

Senior Counsel Lamparello credited special agents of the FBI, under the direction of Special Agent in Charge Stefanie Roddy in Newark, U.S. Department of Health and Human Services Office of Inspector General, under the direction of Special Agent in Charge Naomi Gruchacz, and U.S. Department of Defense, Office of Inspector General, Defense Criminal Investigative Service, Northeast Field Office, under the direction of Special Agent in Charge Christopher M. Silvestro, with the investigation.

The government is represented by Assistant U.S. Attorney Katherine M. Romano, Chief of the General Crimes Unit in Newark.

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Defense counsel: Charles Alvarez, Esq.

Updated December 18, 2025

Topic

HEALTHCARE FRAUD

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Press Release Number: 25-288

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